

PikaCart

Full Build Specification

A solo-owner digital products store + WhatsApp-negotiated custom website service business, built on the existing DigiMarket WordPress theme in Single Seller Mode.

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Status: Ready to build from — every open decision from prior discussion is resolved below.

How to use this document

This is a complete blueprint, not a to-do list. It fixes every field, page, price band and workflow so nothing is decided ad hoc while building. Read it once end to end, mark anything you want changed, then hand it back — the build follows this document exactly.

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1 Executive Summary & Business Model

PikaCart is a single-owner online store at pikacart.in combining two revenue lines under one brand, one login system and one design:

- Digital Products — instantly downloadable files (study notes, resume templates, business templates, design assets, WordPress themes, kids' learning material). Buyer pays online, gets the file immediately.
- Services — custom website development (schools, colleges, committees, shops, cafés, restaurants) shown as a priced catalogue but sold through a WhatsApp conversation, not online checkout. Payment and delivery are agreed off-platform.

This is deliberately not a multi-vendor marketplace. Only the site owner lists items. That single decision removes the GST/TCS/e-commerce-operator obligations that apply to marketplaces, removes the need for Razorpay Route (seller payout splitting), and removes an entire seller-onboarding/KYC subsystem from day one. It can be turned back on later (the underlying software already supports it) if the business ever expands to other sellers.

Why this combination works

- Digital products are passive: built once, sold many times, no back-and-forth.
- Services are high-value but low-volume: a handful of website projects a month at a much higher ticket size funds the business while the digital-product catalogue grows.
- Each pulls the other: a visitor who came for a ₹49 resume template discovers the ₹5,000 website service, and a committee that ordered a website discovers the ₹99 accounts-tracker template.

What changed from the original multi-vendor plan

Area	Original plan (Section spec.pdf)	Final decision (this document)
Sellers	Unlimited third-party sellers, KYC, payouts	Single seller — the site owner only
Commission engine	Global/category/per-seller % + launch promo	Not applicable — all revenue is the owner's
Payment split	Razorpay Route, linked accounts per seller	Not needed. Standard Razorpay account only
GST	Mandatory as an e-commerce operator, any turnover	Normal seller rules — ₹20L threshold applies (confirm with a CA before scaling)
Website-building work	Not in original spec	New: a Services catalogue, WhatsApp-quoted, no online payment

Area	Original plan (Section spec.pdf)	Final decision (this document)
Dashboard sections	Fixed set of categories	Fully admin-editable — see Section 5

2 Market Research Findings

What already exists, and where PikaCart fits

2.1 Solo-seller digital storefronts

Freelancer-facing platforms (Gumroad-style link-in-bio stores, Payhip, SureCart on WordPress) validate the core mechanic: a single creator selling templates and service packages side by side from one page, keeping ownership of the storefront rather than paying a marketplace's cut. The common pattern is a short, visual homepage (portfolio + shop in one), transparent starting prices, and a direct contact channel for anything custom — exactly the split PikaCart is built around.

2.2 Puja/committee financial transparency — a validated, underserved niche

A dedicated open-source tool (GPMS — Ganesh Puja Management System) already exists to digitise a puja committee's donations and expenses, and its standout feature is telling: every donation receipt is QR-coded and shared instantly over WhatsApp, and is publicly verifiable so no one can dispute it later. Separately, established Indian trust/NGO software (Sanstha ERP, TrustSetu) report that digitising donation and expense records measurably cuts accounting disputes and errors for temples and trusts.

Takeaway for PikaCart: build the “Chanda-Kharch Tracker” (Section 6) with a WhatsApp-shareable, QR-coded receipt for every donation entry from day one — it is the single most requested trust feature in this niche, and no low-cost, India-specific competitor currently owns it.

2.3 SEO for a small, single-owner catalogue

Current best practice (2026) for product-style pages is unambiguous and directly shapes Section 10 of this document:

- Every page needs a unique meta title and meta description — duplicating one page's tags on another actively hurts ranking.
- Meta titles: 50–60 characters, primary keyword near the front.
- Meta descriptions: 120–160 characters, one clear benefit + a call to action (they don't affect ranking directly, but they drive the click).
- Structured data (schema.org Product / Service / LocalBusiness markup) is treated as close to mandatory now — it is what lets Google show price, rating and availability directly in search results, and what AI answer engines read to describe a listing.
- Write original description copy per listing; never reuse manufacturer/template boilerplate across items.

2.4 Conclusion

The plan is sound. The two additions this research motivates are: (1) a WhatsApp-shareable QR donation receipt inside the committee tracker product, and (2) treating the SEO fields in Section 10

as mandatory-to-publish, not optional extras, since they are the main free acquisition channel for a one-person business with no ad budget.

3 Who Buys From PikaCart

Persona	What they come for	What convinces them to buy
Student (school/college/competitive exam)	Notes, previous-year papers, project report templates	Free preview page, verified reviews, instant download
Job seeker / fresher	Resume templates, cover letters	Before/after look, ATS-friendly claim, ₹49–199 price point
Small business owner (shop/café/restaurant)	A simple, professional website	Clear starting price, example sites shown, fast WhatsApp reply
School/college admin	An informational website with admissions info, notices	Trust signals (other schools done), AMC/support offered
Puja/festival committee member	A donation-transparent website or the accounts-tracker sheet	Explicit “no one can dispute the numbers” framing, QR receipts
Freelancer/creator	Canva templates, invoice templates, business templates	Bundle pricing, instant download, preview thumbnails
Parent (Kids section)	Worksheets, activity sheets, simple learning templates	Age-band labelling, safe/simple checkout, low price

4 Site Structure — the Two Pillars

4.1 Global navigation

Header: Logo · Categories dropdown · Search · Cart · Account. Footer: About, Categories, Services, Legal, WhatsApp chat button (shown site-wide, not just on service pages).

4.2 Homepage sections, top to bottom

- 1 **Hero** — headline + subheadline (Section 14 gives exact copy) + search bar.
- 2 **Trust strip** — secure payment, instant delivery, WhatsApp support, refund policy — four short icons+lines.
- 3 **Shop by category** — tiles for every top-level category (Section 8), auto-updates as categories are added (Section 5).
- 4 **Trending digital products** — best-selling instant-download items.
- 5 **Website & service packages** — a distinct visual band (different background tint) showing 3–6 service cards with “Starting from ■X” and a WhatsApp button, so it reads as a different kind of offer from the product grid above it.
- 6 **New arrivals.**
- 7 **Footer CTA** — “Need something custom? Chat on WhatsApp.”

4.3 Two listing types, one catalogue

Both Digital Products and Services live in the same product catalogue and share categories/tags/search, but render differently on their own page (Sections 6 and 7) and are visually distinguished everywhere they appear together (a small “Service” tag/badge on the card).

5 Dynamic Sections & Categories

“I want to add whatever section I like, whenever I like” — this section is the answer

This was an explicit requirement: the dashboard must never need a developer to add a new line of business. Everything below is achievable by the site owner alone, in the admin dashboard, in under two minutes each:

5.1 Adding a new category

- 1 Admin → Categories → Add New.
- 2 Type a name (e.g. “Wedding Invitations”), optionally a short description and an icon/emoji.
- 3 Save. It instantly appears in the header dropdown, the homepage “Shop by category” grid, the footer, and the product filter sidebar — no other step.

5.2 Adding a new product or service

Exactly the existing Add Product screen (Section 6/7 lists every field). No category is hard-coded into the software: a product simply gets assigned to whichever categories exist at the time.

5.3 Featuring / reordering what the homepage shows

- Any product can be flagged “Featured” to appear in the homepage hero rotator.
- Any product can be flagged “Service” (Section 7) to render as a WhatsApp-enquiry card instead of a Buy button.
- Homepage section toggles (Trending / New Arrivals / Trust strip) can each be turned on or off from Settings without touching a template.

5.4 What this deliberately does NOT require

- No new database table, no new template file, no developer request for a normal new category or product.
- A genuinely new type of listing (e.g. something that needs its own custom checkout flow entirely unlike “buy instantly” or “WhatsApp enquiry”) is the one case that still needs a small development change — call this out explicitly when it comes up, don't assume it fits the two existing types.

6

Digital Products — Field-by-Field Specification

Every digital product listing captures the following. Fields marked (required to publish) block publishing until filled; others can be saved as draft.

Field	Required?	Notes
Title	Required	Max 70 characters recommended for SEO (see Section 10).
URL slug	Auto-generated	Editable; must stay unique.
Short description	Required	1-2 lines, shown on cards and search results snippet fallback.
Full description	Required	Rich text. What it is, who it's for, what's inside.
"What you get" checklist	Required	New field — a bullet list rendered prominently on the product page, e.g. "PDF, 42 pages · Editable Word file · Lifetime updates." This is the explicit "what we delivered" requirement — it tells the buyer exactly what lands in their inbox before they pay.
Category (one or more)	Required	From the ever-growing list in Section 5.
Tags	Optional	Free-text, comma separated, powers related-items and search.
Price / Sale price	Required	See Section 9 for bands.
Thumbnail image	Required	1:1 or 4:3, min 800×800px.
Gallery (up to 5 images)	Optional but recommended	Screenshots/preview pages sell templates and notes better than any copy.
Delivery type	Required	File download / License key / External link — unchanged from existing system.
Digital file / license keys / link	Required (matching delivery type)	
Download limit / access days	Optional	0 = unlimited / lifetime.
SEO meta title	Required to publish	Section 10 gives the exact formula.
SEO meta description	Required to publish	Section 10 gives the exact formula.
Age band (Kids section only)	Required for Kids category	e.g. "4-6 yrs", "7-9 yrs" — shown as a badge on the card.

Product page layout (buyer-facing)

- 1 Image gallery.
- 2 Title, category, rating & sales count.
- 3 Price box: price, "What you get" checklist, Buy Now / Add to Cart, secure-checkout line.

- 4 Full description.
- 5 Reviews (verified buyers only, unchanged from existing system).
- 6 Related products from the same categories.

7 Services (WhatsApp) — Field-by-Field Specification

A Service uses the same product editor with one toggle switched on: “This is a service (no online payment)”. Turning it on changes both the required fields and the buyer-facing page.

Field	Required?	Notes
Title	Required	e.g. “School & College Website”.
Short & full description	Required	What the service includes at a glance, then in detail.
“What’s included” checklist	Required	e.g. “Up to 6 pages · Admissions form · Mobile-friendly · 1 free revision round · 3 months free support.”
Starting price	Required	Shown as “Starting from ₹X” — informational, not a checkout price (Section 9).
Turnaround time	Required	e.g. “5–7 working days after we confirm requirements.” Sets expectations before the WhatsApp chat even starts.
Category	Required	“Website Services” as parent, sub-category per audience (School, Committee, Shop/Café, etc.).
Thumbnail + gallery	Required	Screenshots of 2–3 real or example sites in that category — the single biggest trust builder per the research in Section 2.
Service WhatsApp number	Optional	Falls back to the site-wide default number in Settings if left blank — lets you route different service lines to different numbers later if needed.
Pre-filled WhatsApp message	Optional	Falls back to an auto-generated “Hi, I’m interested in [service name]” message.
SEO meta title / description	Required to publish	Section 10.

Service page layout (buyer-facing) — differs from a Digital Product

- 1 Image gallery (portfolio screenshots).
- 2 Title, category.
- 3 Price box: “Starting from ■X”, turnaround time, “What’s included” checklist, single button — “■ Enquire on WhatsApp” (no Buy Now, no Add to Cart, no cart icon interaction at all).
- 4 Full description.
- 5 No reviews section at launch (services aren’t “verified purchases” in the same sense) — revisit once a few projects are delivered and testimonials exist as static content instead.

The WhatsApp-to-delivery flow, end to end

- 1 Visitor reads the service page, clicks Enquire on WhatsApp — opens a chat with a pre-filled message naming the service.
- 2 Owner discusses requirements, agrees a final price and timeline in chat.

- 3 Owner collects payment directly (UPI/bank transfer) — **outside** PikaCart's checkout, by design (Section 1 explains why).
- 4 Owner builds and delivers the site; hands over access/credentials over WhatsApp or email.
- 5 If a requirement genuinely can't be delivered, the owner refunds the amount collected directly (this is a manual promise made in the service's refund copy, not a platform-enforced refund, since payment never went through PikaCart for services).

Because this is a manual, chat-based promise rather than a payment-gateway refund, the service description must say explicitly: "If we cannot deliver what was agreed, you get a full refund of any amount already paid." Put this sentence on every service page and in the WhatsApp opening message template.

8 Category Plan at Launch

8.1 Digital Products

Category	Starter items to list	Typical price
Study Notes	Board/college notes, previous-year question papers, project report templates	₹29 – ₹199
Resume & Career	Resume templates, cover letter templates, LinkedIn banner templates	₹49 – ₹149
Business & Committee Tools	Invoice template, quotation template, Chanda-Kharch (donation/expense) Tracker with WhatsApp-shareable QR receipts	₹99 – ₹499
Design Templates	Canva social media packs, poster/banner templates, logo templates	₹49 – ₹299
WordPress & Tech Templates	Ready-made website templates (buyer self-installs) — School, Committee, Café/Restaurant themes	₹999 – ₹2,999
Kids Zone	Worksheets, activity sheets, simple flashcard sets, colouring templates, age-banded	₹29 – ₹99

8.2 Services

Sub-category	Starting price shown	What's typically included
School / College Website	Starting ₹5,000	Up to 6 pages, admissions enquiry form, notices section, mobile-friendly
Puja / Committee Website	Starting ₹3,000	Donation & expense tracker page, event gallery, committee members page
Shop / Café / Restaurant Website	Starting ₹4,000	Menu/catalogue page, location & hours, WhatsApp order button
Business / Portfolio Website	Starting ₹3,500	About, services, contact, portfolio gallery
Website Maintenance (AMC)	Starting ₹999 / year	Uptime checks, content updates, minor fixes

These are starting anchors to display, not fixed contracts — the real price is agreed on WhatsApp per Section 7. Revisit every quarter against actual quotes given.

9 Pricing Strategy & Price Bands

9.1 Digital products — three-tier ladder

Tier	Price band	Use for
Entry	₹29 – ₹99	Single-page templates, worksheets, small note sets — low-friction impulse buys that build trust and reviews fast.
Core	₹149 – ₹499	Full note sets, multi-template packs, the accounts tracker — the main revenue tier.
Premium	₹999+	Ready-made website templates, large bundles — fewer buyers, higher margin.

9.2 Discount pricing

- Use the existing “sale price” field to show a struck-through original price — the theme already renders this with a percentage-off badge.
- Reserve real discounts (20–40%) for a launch week and festival periods (Diwali, New Year, exam season for notes) rather than running them constantly, or the strike-through loses credibility.

9.3 Services — pricing logic to use in WhatsApp negotiation

Base every quote on three inputs, stated out loud to the client so pricing feels reasoned, not arbitrary:

- 1 **Base package price** (the “Starting from” shown on-site) for the standard scope.
- 2 **+ per extra page/feature** beyond the standard scope (e.g. +₹500 per extra page, +₹1,000 for a payment/donation gateway integration).
- 3 **+ rush fee** if turnaround is compressed below the stated standard (e.g. +25% for under-3-day delivery).

9.4 Annual review

Revisit every price band once a quarter against: (a) actual conversion data from the site, (b) what similar solo sellers charge on Instagram/Etsy-equivalent channels for the same categories, (c) whether the entry tier is still driving enough reviews to justify its low margin.

10 SEO Specification

Mandatory to publish, not optional — see Section 2.3 for why

10.1 Meta title formula

[Primary keyword / product name] – [Key benefit or category] | PikaCart

Example: “CBSE Class 10 Physics Notes PDF – Chapter-wise | PikaCart”. Keep to 50–60 characters including “| PikaCart”. Never reuse a title across two listings.

10.2 Meta description formula

[What it is] + [who it's for / key benefit] + [call to action]. 120–160 characters.

Example: “Chapter-wise CBSE Class 10 Physics notes with solved examples. Instant PDF download, lifetime access. Buy now for exam-ready revision.”

10.3 Per-listing checklist (blocks publish if incomplete)

- Unique meta title (Section 10.1 formula).
- Unique meta description (Section 10.2 formula).
- At least one image with descriptive alt text (e.g. “cbse-class-10-physics-notes-cover.jpg”, not “IMG1234.jpg”).
- Product assigned to at least one category (drives the schema breadcrumb and internal linking).

10.4 Site-wide technical SEO (already largely built into the theme, verify at launch)

- Structured data: Product schema (price, currency, availability) on every digital product; Service/LocalBusiness-style markup on service pages once the business address/area served is finalised.
- XML sitemap auto-generated and submitted to Google Search Console (see Section 17, launch checklist).
- Clean URLs (already in place: /product/..., /category-products/...).
- Mobile-first: test every new page on a real phone before publishing, not just desktop preview.

10.5 Ongoing content SEO

- One blog post a month minimum targeting a buyer search phrase (“best resume format for freshers 2026”, “how to track puja committee donations transparently”) that links to 2–3 relevant products/services.
- Encourage every buyer to leave a review — review text is unique, keyword-rich content Google indexes for free.

11 Buyer Journey & Buyer Dashboard

11.1 Digital product purchase flow (unchanged, already built and tested)

- 1 Browse/search → product page → Add to Cart or Buy Now.
- 2 Checkout → Razorpay payment (UPI/card/netbanking).
- 3 Instant confirmation page with download button; confirmation email sent.
- 4 Item always available again from My Account → My Purchases.

11.2 Service enquiry flow

- 1 Browse service page → “Enquire on WhatsApp” → chat opens with pre-filled context.
- 2 No account, login or payment required to enquire — keep this frictionless since it's a lead-generation step, not a transaction.

11.3 Buyer dashboard (“My Account”) — unchanged from existing build

- My Purchases (instant re-download), Order History with downloadable invoices, Wishlist, Profile, Support ticket for any order issue.

12 Admin Dashboard Requirements

12.1 Already built (verify still fits Single Seller Mode)

- Overview: revenue, orders, top products, sales trend chart.
- Products: full CRUD as specified in Sections 6–7, bulk publish/unpublish/duplicate/delete.
- Orders: full order list with filters, CSV export, refund action.
- Reviews, Coupons, Support tickets, Audit log — unchanged.
- Settings → Single Seller Mode toggle, default WhatsApp number (already shipped).

12.2 New for this plan

Requirement	Why
“What you get” / “What's included” checklist field on every listing	Explicit deliverable requirement from this brief — Sections 6–7.
Per-category icon/emoji field	So homepage category tiles look designed, not default, as new sections are added — Section 5.
Simple analytics: which categories/services get the most WhatsApp clicks vs. page views	Tells the owner where to add more listings next, without needing Google Analytics literacy.

13 Payments, Refunds & Money Flow

13.1 Digital products

Unchanged: Razorpay Checkout, standard account (no Route/linked accounts needed in Single Seller Mode — already implemented and tested). Refunds are issued from the admin order screen and automatically revoke file access.

13.2 Services

No online payment on PikaCart at all. Money moves owner ↔ client directly (UPI/bank transfer), negotiated on WhatsApp per Section 7. The refund promise is a written policy commitment, honoured manually.

13.3 What stays true either way

- Never store card details — Razorpay Checkout handles this entirely; PikaCart never sees or stores card numbers.
- Every digital-product transaction is logged in the admin ledger with a CSV export for accounting/GST purposes.

14 Branding, Design & Content Voice

14.1 Already delivered

- Logo pack (SVG/PNG/favicon), colour palette (Indigo #5B4BFF primary, Violet/Yellow accents), Poppins typography — already produced and in the repo.

14.2 Homepage copy (final, ready to paste in)

Headline: “India Ka Digital Products Marketplace”

Subheadline: “Ebooks, courses, templates, software aur bahut kuch. UPI se pay karo, turant download.”

(Swap in a services-forward variant seasonally, e.g. during a school-admissions season: “Websites Built for Schools, Shops & Committees — Notes & Templates for Everyone Else.”)

14.3 Voice

- Digital products copy: short, benefit-first, in Hinglish where natural (matches the audience research in Section 3).
- Service copy: confident and specific about turnaround/inclusions (Section 7) — vague service pages are the single biggest trust-killer for a solo freelancer site.

15 Legal, Tax & Compliance Summary

This section is a plain-language summary for planning purposes only — confirm every figure with a CA before launch, as rules and thresholds change.

- Single seller → normal GST rules. Because PikaCart is not a marketplace with third-party sellers, the mandatory-registration-regardless-of-turnover rule for e-commerce operators does not apply. The standard threshold for services (commonly cited around ₹20 lakh/year) applies instead — confirm the current figure with a CA.
- Government-employee side-business rule. If the owner is a government employee, most conduct rules require written permission before running any private trade/business — independent of GST. Resolve this before the business takes real payments (a family member's name is a common workaround, discussed and left as an open decision for the owner).
- Standard legal pages (already generated by the theme): Terms of Service, Privacy Policy, Refund Policy. Still to write: a Contact Us page and a plain-language Delivery/Service Policy page explicitly covering the WhatsApp service flow's refund promise (Section 7).
- Keep the CSV export of all transactions (already built) as the source data for whichever tax filing route is chosen.

16 Analytics & Growth Plan

First 90 days

- 1 Week 1–2: finish Contact Us + Delivery Policy pages, submit sitemap to Google Search Console, connect WhatsApp Business number.
- 2 Week 3–4: publish the full Section 8 starter catalogue (aim: 15–20 digital products, 4–6 service listings live).
- 3 Month 2: first blog post, start asking every buyer for a review, share service portfolio screenshots on Instagram/WhatsApp status.
- 4 Month 3: review Section 9 pricing against real conversion data; add the next category based on what buyers actually search for on-site (built-in search logs which terms return zero results — that's the next product to make).

17 Launch Checklist

Task	Owner	Status
Single Seller Mode ON, default WhatsApp number set	Site owner	☐
Contact Us page written and published	Site owner	☐
Delivery / Service Policy page written and published	Site owner	☐
15–20 starter digital products published (Section 8.1), each with SEO fields complete (Section 10.3)	Site owner	☐
4–6 service listings published (Section 8.2) with portfolio screenshots	Site owner	☐
Razorpay: activation form submitted, test order + refund verified	Site owner	☐
Google Search Console verified, sitemap submitted	Site owner	☐
SMTP email sending verified (order confirmations, verification emails)	Site owner	☐
GST / government-employee question resolved with a professional	Site owner + CA/lawyer	☐
Go live with real Razorpay keys	Site owner	☐

End of specification. Build proceeds section by section against this document; any change during the build gets written back in here first, then implemented — so this stays the single source of truth.